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50 years of Batman

Half a century of Batman movies



It's been 50 years since the masked vigilante from Gotham made his first appearance on screen, and it has been an incredible journey. The Batman movies have observed huge disappointments *cough* Batman and Robin *cough* whereas it has also witnessed impressive characterisations such as the iconic role of The Joker played by Heath Ledger (while some may argue that Jack Nicholson's role in Batman also deserves the same appreciation). The intention behind this story is to pay a tribute to all those movies and what better way than going on a Batman movie marathon. Here's a list of all the movies that built Batman's legacy through 50 years, alongside the comic book universe.

Batman (1966)

The first Batman movie to hit the theatres, the franchise was already seeing a lot of positive responses after a successful run on TV. It's unlikely that you've watched this movie considering how old it is. The effects and dialogues look incredibly silly in contrast to the movies we see today. You will however recognise the popular Batman song "nananananana Batman!", and the quirky text animations of "Pow", "Bam", "Zap" etc. Adam West donned the role of Batman, who also played the same role in the TV show.

Batman (1989)

After a long exile, Tim Burton was roped in for the long awaited movie, three years in making. Michael Keaton played Batman while Jack Nicholson performed an impressive role as The Joker. The movie was well received by fans since it stayed in line with the comic books.

Batman Returns (1992)

The 1989 Batman saw huge success and to cash in on it, Tim Burton was back with almost the same cast. This time, Penguin was the villain played by Danny DeVito, who gave an equally brilliant performance as Nicholson. Also, not to forget Michelle Pfeiffer's role as Catwoman. This movie had better special effects and a bigger story, clearly making it the best Batman movie of the time.

Batman Forever (1995)

Although Batman Returns was phenomenally great, it was kind of dark and scary for the kids. To make it more peppy and cater to a younger audience, Batman Forever went back to its roots being a quirky and funny movie. This movie saw a new Batman being played by Val Kilmer and many more characters such as Robin, Riddler and Two face. Jim Carrey put his hilarious acting skills to use as The Riddler.

Batman and Robin (1997)

This movie had an incredible roster of actors but it didn't do quite as well as expected in the box office. George Clooney plays a decent Bruce Wayne and we see Chris O'Donnell return as Robin. Alicia Silverstone plays Batgirl, Uma Thurman takes the role of Poison Ivy, and Arnold Schwarzenegger plays Mr. Freeze. The villains weren't able to pull off a menacing antagonist to Batman.

The Dark Knight Trilogy (2005-12)

It had been eight years since the last Batman movie, the reason being the previous one tanking in the box office. The torch had been passed on to Nolan. He was on a mission to make Batman more dark and realistic and boy did he pull it off. Batman Begins, the first one in the trilogy, was a success that focused on creating a more believable universe, building the background for important characters. Christian Bale played both the characters of Batman and Bruce Wayne pretty well throughout the trilogy. Among the three, The Dark Knight (2008) could arguably be the best Batman movie ever made. Heath Ledger stole the show with an epic portrayal of The Joker that even won him an Academy award. The Dark Knight Rises (2012) was the final movie from Nolan, again with an incredible performance by Tom Hardy as Bane. Even if one isn't a Batman fan, it would be really difficult to come across someone who hasn't watched one of these movies.

Dawn of Justice (2016)

The latest rendition of Batman played by Ben Affleck witnessed mixed reactions from fans and critics. We get to see the Son of Gotham take on the Son of Krypton. Affleck pulls off a dark and gloomy Batman and did justice to the role in our opinion. We're definitely looking forward to his performance in the upcoming Justice League movie. 